

albissus

BRAND GUIDE V1.0

UPDATED 2026-08-29

PALETTE BLACK & YELLOW

THEME

§1 / THE NAME

albissus

/æɪˈbɪsəs/ · an invented word — a bright, mysterious light, often associated with knowledge.

Always lowercase as a logo. In running prose it takes a normal capital: “Albissus builds...”. Never all-caps, never camel-cased, never hyphenated. It is a singular entity — “Albissus is”, not “Albissus are”.

One-line descriptor, used verbatim in bios, decks and directory listings:

Albissus builds immersive VR simulations, digital media, and marketing for organisations that dream big.

§2 / LOGO

A wordmark and a pulse

The identity is two parts: the lowercase *albissus* wordmark set in IBM Plex Mono 600, and the three-dot mark — a stand-in for a signal, a heartbeat, a loading state.

WORDMARK — PRIMARY

albissus

THREE-DOT MARK — PULSES ON A 2.4S STAGGER



Clear space & minimum size

Keep clear space around the mark equal to the height of one full character of the wordmark. Minimum wordmark size is 90 px wide on screen (≈ 24 px cap height); below that, use the three-dot mark alone.



Colour

The wordmark appears in exactly three colours: **Signal yellow** on dark grounds, **Ink** or **Paper** on the opposite ground. Nothing else.

DO

- Set it only in IBM Plex Mono 600, lowercase.
- Signal yellow on Ink / black; Ink on Paper.
- Give it a full character-height of clear space.

DON'T

- Put the yellow wordmark on Paper — 2.1:1 contrast.
- Add glow, bevel, gradient, outline or drop shadow.
- Re-space, stretch or recolour the three dots.
- Substitute another mono or a sans face.

- Use the dot mark alone when space is tight.

Open action: the raster assets in /img (albissus-dots.png, albissus-logo-transparent.png) and favicon.ico are still the previous indigo/gold. Regenerate them in Ink #1c1c1c and Signal yellow #F59E0B before the next deploy.

§3 / COLOUR

Black, yellow, and just enough grey

Two brand colours doing almost all the work: near-black grounds and a single warm yellow accent. Everything else is a neutral or a hairline. The source of truth is the :root block in styles.css.

Aa

Ink

hex #1c1c1c

rgb 28 28 28

token --ink

role primary ground

Aa

True black

hex #000000

rgb 0 0 0

token --ink-deep

role deepest sections,
footer

Aa

Paper

hex #FAF8F8

rgb 250 250 248

token --paper

role readable sections,
cards

Aa

Aa

Aa

Paper ink

hex #1A1A1A

rgb 26 26 26

token --paper-ink

role body copy on Paper

Signal yellow

hex #F59E0B

rgb 245 158 11

token --gold

role accent – CTAs,
wordmark, focus

Bronze

hex #8A6D3B

rgb 138 109 59

token --gold-dim

role accent text on Paper

Aa

Ash

hex #A6A6A6

rgb 166 166 166

token --lavender

role secondary text on
dark

Hairlines

dark 245 158 11 / .24

paper 26 26 26 / .12

token --line-on-*

role borders, dividers

Contrast & pairing

Yellow is a text colour only on dark grounds. On Paper it reads at 2.1:1 — use it as a fill, or switch accent text to Bronze.

FOREGROUND	BACKGROUND	RATIO	RATING
Signal yellow #F59E0B	Ink #1c1c1c	7.9:1	AAA
Paper #FAFAF8	Ink #1c1c1c	16:1	AAA
Ash #A6A6A6	Ink #1c1c1c	7.0:1	AAA
Paper ink #1A1A1A	Paper #FAFAF8	16:1	AAA
Bronze #8A6D3B	Paper #FAFAF8	4.6:1	AA · normal text
Signal yellow #F59E0B	Paper #FAFAF8	2.1:1	Fail · fills only

Proportion

Roughly 70% ground (Ink or Paper), 25% neutrals and type, 5% Signal yellow. If a screen looks yellow, it has too much. The accent marks the one thing that matters on a given view — the primary action, the live state, the keyword.

§4 / TYPOGRAPHY

Mono for structure, sans for sentences

IBM Plex Mono sets everything structural — the wordmark, headings, labels, buttons. IBM Plex Sans carries running text. The mono gives the brand its engineered, terminal-adjacent character; the sans keeps paragraphs comfortable.

IBM PLEX MONO — DISPLAY & STRUCTURAL · WEIGHTS 400 / 500 / 600

albissus

Regular 400 Medium 500 SemiBold 600

IBM PLEX SANS — BODY · WEIGHTS 400 / 500

We build immersive VR simulations, digital media content, and marketing campaigns for organisations that dream big.

Type scale

Mirrors the live values in `styles.css`. Headings track -0.01em ; uppercase labels track $+0.14$ to $+0.16\text{em}$.

ROLE	FACE	SIZE	WEIGHT	CASE
Hero word	Plex Mono	<code>clamp(3rem, 10vw, 6.5rem)</code>	600	lower
Section title	Plex Mono	<code>clamp(1.6rem, 3vw, 2.25rem)</code>	500	Sentence

ROLE	FACE	SIZE	WEIGHT	CASE
Sub-head / card	Plex Mono	1.05rem	500	Sentence
Lede	Plex Sans	1.05rem	400	Sentence
Body	Plex Sans	1rem / 1.6	400	Sentence
Eyebrow / label	Plex Mono	0.75rem	500	UPPER
Button	Plex Mono	0.9rem	500	Sentence

Rules

- Sentence case for headings and buttons. UPPERCASE only for eyebrows and metadata labels, always letter-spaced.
- Keep running text near 65–70 characters per line.
- Load only the weights in use: Mono 400/500/600, Sans 400/500.
- Fallbacks: `ui-monospace`, `Menlo`, `monospace` and `-apple-system`, `'Segoe UI'`, `sans-serif`.

§5 / VOICE & TONE

Plain-spoken. Confident. Quietly playful.

Albissus is a small team that does ambitious technical work. The writing should sound like a person who knows the craft explaining it without inflating it — short sentences, concrete nouns, the occasional dry aside.

DO

- “We build immersive VR simulations, digital media, and marketing.”
- “Six ways we bring your ideas to screen — or headset.”
- “A small team, built for this specifically.”

DON'T

- “We leverage cutting-edge XR to unlock synergies.”
- “Our Comprehensive Service Portfolio.”
- “A world-class team of industry veterans.”

- “Tell us what you’re trying to build.”

- “Contact us today for a free consultation!”

Conventions

- Second person for the reader (“your idea”), first-person plural for Albissus (“we build”).
- Serial comma. Em dashes for asides, spaced en dash if you must.
- One exclamation mark per project, maximum. Usually zero.
- “VR”, “3D”, “XR” are fine unspelled; avoid coining new acronyms.

Boilerplate – long

Albissus is a digital media studio building immersive VR simulations, 3D web applications, neurofeedback tools, and the video and marketing that carry them. We work with organisations in education, training, and research that want to put something ambitious in front of people — on screen, or in a headset.

§6 / MOTION

One ambient pulse, everything else on interaction

Motion in the identity is restrained. The three-dot mark breathes; a few elements respond to the pointer; the hero types itself once. Nothing scrolls on its own.



Pulse — opacity 0.35→1, scale 0.82→1, 2.4s ease-in-out, dots staggered 0.25s.

- **Hero eyebrow** types on once (per-character), the caret blinks, then it rests. It does not loop.
- **Phonetic spelling** flips letter-by-letter — rotateX, 0.09s per tick.
- **Buttons** lift 1 px on hover; **cards** lift 3 px with a soft Ink shadow.
- **Transitions** are 0.15–0.2s ease. No bounce, no spring.
- No parallax, no scroll-jacking, no autoplaying video or audio.
- Everything collapses to $\leq 0.01\text{ms}$ under prefers-reduced-motion.

§7 / LAYOUT & COMPONENTS

A 1080 px column and hairline edges

Content sits in a centred 1080 px container with a 1.75 rem gutter. Sections alternate Ink and Paper grounds and are separated by a single hairline, never a heavy rule.

TOKEN	VALUE	USE
Container	1080px	max content width
Gutter	1.75rem	side padding
Section rhythm	6rem / 4rem	desktop / $\leq 720\text{px}$
Grid gap	1.75rem	cards, tags
Radius — button	2px	buttons, nav CTA
Radius — card	6px	cards, panels
Radius — control	4px	inputs, toggles
Radius — pill	999px	tags

Components

Primary action

Ghost action

• Tag

- **Primary button** — Signal yellow fill, Ink text, 2 px radius. One per view.
- **Ghost button** — hairline border, inherits text colour; border goes yellow on hover.
- **Card** — Paper/panel fill, 1 px hairline, 6 px radius, 2 rem padding.
- **Pill** — hairline border, 999 px radius, 6 px yellow dot as bullet.
- **Focus** — 2 px Signal yellow outline, 3 px offset, everywhere.

§8 / APPLICATIONS

Where it shows up

Favicon & app icon

Three-dot mark, Signal yellow on Ink, centred, no wordmark. Supply 16, 32, 180 and 512 px. Dots stay static in the icon — no motion.

Social / Open Graph

1200×630. Wordmark plus dot mark, left-aligned on an Ink field, one character-height of clear space. The current `og:image` points to `img/albissus-dots.png` — replace with a recoloured card.

Email signature

Tahsina Mahmud

FOUNDER & CREATIVE DIRECTOR

Albissus · albissus.ca

Name in Plex Mono 600, role as a spaced uppercase label in Bronze, domain link in Signal yellow (dark clients) or Bronze (light). No logo image in the signature — keep it text.

Source of truth — `styles.css :root`. This guide mirrors those tokens; if they diverge, the stylesheet wins.

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